

Title

Evaluating a Targeted Educational Resource to Increase Ophthalmic Screening Participation Among Young-Adult Patients With Type 2 Diabetes: A Randomized Pragmatic Trial

Abstract

Diabetic retinopathy represents a leading cause of vision loss in working-age adults, yet young patients with type 2 diabetes show persistently low retinal screening participation. Evidence-based behavioral interventions may enhance engagement. This pragmatic randomized trial will compare targeted educational materials against usual care in young adults aged 18-39 with type 2 diabetes. Participants will be stratified by prior screening history and randomized to receive either a brief, evidence-based educational leaflet or standard information. The primary outcome is patient-initiated retinal screening within 4 weeks among those with no prior screening history. Secondary outcomes include measured changes in knowledge about retinopathy, perceived risk susceptibility, beliefs about screening value, stated behavioral intentions, and perceived barriers. Approximately 130 participants will be enrolled. Baseline sociodemographic factors and clinical characteristics will be documented. Analysis will employ intention-to-treat methodology and will examine potential interactions by participant demographic and clinical characteristics.